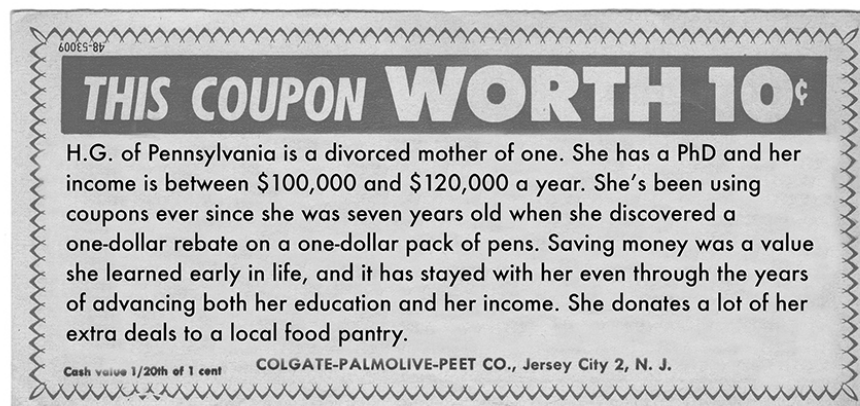


so. According to a May 2010 WSL Strategic Retail bulletin, 58 percent of respondents said they liked using coupons because it makes them feel smart.

“Coupons give the consumer a tangible form of savings,” says Matt Wallaert, a behavioral psychologist and the lead scientist at Churnless.com, a digital strategy and production company. “The coupon users can tell themselves that this little piece of paper that they have cut [out] and redeemed entitles them to a discount that others don’t have. It gives the consumer a sense of control over their savings. When they get something free because of the coupon, it is even better. One of the things that makes us feel smart is getting something for free. During a recession, frugal is not a bad word. It’s a good word. This is something that people are supposed to be doing. They’re searching for free more than ever because it’s a symbol of financially savviness.” Thus, even a wealthy consumer can feel smarter by using coupons.



But it isn’t all about the savings or the feeling of beating the system with a good deal. Ambuj Jain, an assistant marketing professor at Southern